PHIL 3042 | Course Syllabus

Philosophy of Technology: Organology, the Organic & the Inorganic

Monsoon / Spring 2025 – 2026 | Seminar | Ashoka University

Course description

An upper-level seminar examining continental philosophies of technology and how technical objects and systems support specific spiritual practices, traditions, and forms of social cohesion. Tracing the relation between the organic and the inorganic from Georges Canguilhem and Gilbert Simondon to Bernard Stiegler, Sylvia Wynter, and Yuk Hui, students investigate technical exteriorization, tertiary retention, and pharmacology.

Seminar schedule

WK 01 - The Organic & The Inorganic: Vital Norms and Technical Life

- Georges Canguilhem (1952), Machine and Organism (in Knowledge of Life)

WK 02 - Concretization, Transindividuation & Technical Objects

- Gilbert Simondon (1958), On the Mode of Existence of Technical Objects, Part I & III

WK 03 - Epiphylogenesis, Tertiary Retention & Pharmacology

- Bernard Stiegler (1998), Technics and Time, 1: The Fault of Epimetheus

WK 04 - Cosmotechnics, Sociogeny & Decolonial Orientations

- Yuk Hui (2016), The Question Concerning Technology in China: An Essay in Cosmotechnics

PROTOTYPE - DUMMY DATA - STAGING PREVIEW